Akanksha Sharma

Data Analytics Specialist — Institutional Research & Planning

POWER BI · SQL · PYTHON · TABLEAU

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analytics professional with more than six years of full-time experience turning data into decisions across fintech, automotive data, government IT, consulting, and higher-education institutional research. Currently Data Analytics Specialist in the University of North Carolina Wilmington's Office of Institutional Research & Planning — building institutional reports and dashboards, strengthening data quality, and partnering with campus stakeholders. Doctor of Information Technology (DIT) doctoral student at Trine University (4.00 GPA).

EXPERIENCE

Data Analytics Specialist — University of North Carolina Wilmington May 2026 – Present

Full-time · Wilmington, NC (On-site)

Support data-informed decision-making across the university by building and maintaining institutional reports and dashboards. Ensure data quality and consistency across analytical outputs. Partner with campus stakeholders to clarify reporting requirements and communicate findings in accessible language. Apply SQL, Python, Tableau, and statistical analysis to institutional analytics use cases. Designated Community Expert in AI Currents, UNCW's internal AI community on Viva Engage — one of six designated experts in a 103-member community (verified Oct 27, 2026).

Founder & Creator — AI Radar with Akanksha Oct 2026 – Present

Independent / Self-employed · Remote

Weekly AI explainer series across Substack, YouTube, Instagram, LinkedIn and a daily web brief. I direct an end-to-end AI production pipeline: story selection from primary sources, plain-language scriptwriting, generative video production (Google Veo 3.1 via Flow), AI avatar direction and performance design, compositing of verified data graphics (Python, PIL, FFmpeg), voice and audio production, and retention-first packaging. Every number published is sourced and verified before it ships.

Skills: Generative AI Video (Veo 3.1, Google Flow) · AI Avatar Design & Direction · Prompt Engineering · Video Production & Compositing (FFmpeg, Python/PIL) · Data Storytelling · Content Strategy · AI News Analysis · Audio Production · Editorial Verification · Voice & Audio Direction · Brand Identity & Logo Design · Animation & Performance Direction · Packaging & Retention Design · Trademark & Brand Protection · Intellectual Property Management

Founder — Sharma Digital Studio Nov 2026 – Present

Independent / Self-employed · Remote

Founded a small web studio for clinics and local businesses — websites that turn searches into bookings: design, build, online booking systems, staff dashboards and local SEO. Studio site: sharmauncw.github.io/sharma-digital-studio

Client #1 delivered Nov 8, 2026: Gathrika Skin Clinic (Medipally, Hyderabad) — full website with live online booking (clinic-hours slots, capacity limits, blocked days) and a clinic staff dashboard. Live: sharmauncw.github.io/gathrika-skin-clinic

Consultant — Source Mantra Aug 2024 – Jun 2025

Full-time · Remote

Delivered client-focused data and analytics support using Python and SQL for reporting, analysis, and business problem-solving. Performed statistical analysis to identify patterns and translate results into stakeholder-ready insights. Partnered with remote stakeholders to align deliverables to requirements.

Intern — MOTOR Information Systems Sep 2023 – Aug 2024

Internship · Hybrid (Troy, MI)

Completed a year-long hybrid internship supporting data initiatives in the automotive information space. Assisted with data organization, validation, and reporting support. Built automotive data context that informed subsequent Power BI dashboard development.

Backend Data Specialist — CredAble Jun 2020 – Nov 2022

Full-time · Remote (Mumbai Metropolitan Region, India)

Managed backend data operations for a fintech company with emphasis on dependable data processing, organization, and accuracy. Supported database work, data maintenance, and issue resolution. Collaborated cross-functionally to improve data usability for business reporting.

Technical Data Associate — Fast Enterprises, LLC Jan 2016 – Dec 2018

Full-time · On-site (Atlanta, GA)

Supported government IT implementations with data conversion, validation, and reporting. Provided technical data support, issue resolution, and operational delivery with attention to data integrity and stakeholder service.

Engineering Co-op — Technicolor Aug 2012 – Aug 2015

Purdue University co-op program

Completed 4 of 5 co-op terms through Purdue's co-op program.

Campus Ambassador — McGraw Hill Aug 2014 – May 2015

Purdue University

Student Ambassador promoting McGraw Hill learning products and resources on campus.

SPEAKING

Guest Lecturer — "Data Visualization (Session 1)" Oct 14, 2026

EDL 586/686 Program Evaluation, Watson College of Education, UNCW

Delivered a mini-lecture plus a hands-on "Bad Data Clinic" activity via Zoom; invited by Dr. Satlaj Dighe.

Guest Lecturer — "Before You Trust a Number (Session 2)" Oct 28, 2026

EDL 586/686 Program Evaluation, Watson College of Education, UNCW

Delivered a 35-minute Zoom session on judging whether a number can be trusted before it is released — data recipes and snapshots, verification checks, and governance — with a live Tableau demonstration and anonymous student polls; invited by Dr. Satlaj Dighe.

PROJECTS

IPEDS Outcomes Lab — Python · Machine Learning · SHAP · github.com/sharmauncw/ipeds-outcomes-lab

Built an outcomes-modeling lab on the federal IPEDS panel, 2015–2023: 60,885 institution-years across 8,670 institutions. Graduation-rate model: R^2 0.745, MAE 7.15 percentage points. First-year retention is the top SHAP driver of graduation rates (9.49). Pell vs. non-Pell 8-year award rates: 45.9% vs. 62.2% — a 16.4-percentage-point gap (IPEDS Outcome Measures, student-weighted).

Rocky Presents — AI Avatar Explainer Series — Veo 3.1 · Google Flow · Python · FFmpeg

An animated AI presenter performs weekly data stories, acting each beat while real, verified data graphics are composited onto in-scene screens timed to her gestures. Built with Veo 3.1 native-dialogue generation, performance direction, and perspective-mapped data overlays.

Student Success Benchmark — Power BI · DAX · Python · Streamlit · github.com/sharmauncw/student-success-benchmark

Peer-benchmarked student-success analytics on synthetic data: a star-schema model with DAX measures and an interactive Streamlit/Plotly demo.

Streaming Content Analytics — Python · scikit-learn · DuckDB · SQL · github.com/sharmauncw/streaming-content-analytics

End-to-end analysis of the MovieLens catalog and ratings: pandas EDA, k-means catalog segmentation, a content-based recommender, and analytical SQL in DuckDB.

Retail Sales Forecasting — Python · Holt-Winters · DuckDB · github.com/sharmauncw/retail-sales-forecasting

Ninety-day sales forecast with confidence bands on synthetic retail data: Holt-Winters exponential smoothing, residual-based anomaly detection, and a DuckDB analytics mart for month-over-month store and category performance.

Automotive Repair Data Dashboard — Power BI · SQL Server · SQL

Interactive Power BI dashboard for automotive repair data, built with reusable Power Query transformations and DAX measures for KPIs, trends, and time intelligence on a fact/dimension semantic model.

Bad Chart Clinic — Python · Matplotlib · github.com/sharmauncw/bad-chart-clinic

Six pairs of misleading vs. corrected data visualizations with numerically honest fixes — a teaching clinic for honest chart design.

Talking Resume Pipeline — Python · github.com/sharmauncw/talking-resume-pipeline

Automated pipeline that turns a resume into a narrated video: scripted narration, TTS voiceover, subtitles, and assembled video.

Enrollment What-If Simulator — Python · Streamlit · github.com/sharmauncw/enrollment-whatif-simulator

Scenario-modeling tool for enrollment planning — adjust policy levers and project outcomes forward; no fitted models, no leakage.

WiFi Indoor Navigation System — Purdue ECE senior capstone (Spring 2015)

Indoor positioning system that fuses multiple sensor techniques (including WiFi) to navigate an object indoors, where GPS signals can't penetrate; built by a team of 4 — Sidharth Mudgal, Akanksha Sharma, Suppatach Sabpisal, Daulet Kenzhebalin (Group 7). Purdue course archive record: https://engineering.purdue.edu/ece477/Archive/archive.php (select Spring 2015, Group 7).

Banner-Style Datamart SQL Patterns — SQL · github.com/sharmauncw/banner-datamart-sql-patterns

Sanitized SQL reporting patterns for higher-ed datamarts — cohort definitions, retention, DFW rates, course-outcome analysis.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Information Technology, Trine University — Jun 2025 – Dec 2030 (expected)

GPA 4.00

Coursework: Data Science & Big Data; Computer Science with Python (A); Network Management (A); Graduate Internship. In progress: Cybersecurity (DIT 7013, starting Oct 2026).

M.S., Management Information Systems, Oakland University — Jan 2023 – Jun 2024

GPA 3.30

Selected by Prof. Vijayan Sugumaran to represent Oakland University at the 12th annual Great Lakes Data, AI & Analytics Summit (Apr 18, 2024, Detroit Marriott Troy) — Michigan's only data & analytics summit of its kind, 350+ practitioners; attended with a sponsored ticket as a student delegate alongside faculty and fellow students.

B.S., Computer Engineering, Purdue University — Aug 2011 – Dec 2015

GPA 3.23

Dean's List; Society of Women Engineers award; Technicolor co-op (4 terms); full Stanford summer-school scholarship.

CERTIFICATIONS

Introduction to Cybersecurity Tools and Cyberattacks V3 — IBM (via Coursera) — Nov 2026 · Verify: credly.com/badges/1d53cb72-a946-4a34-abd3-6b1dfbfd119e

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — Jan 2024 – Jan 2027

Post Graduate Program in Data Science and Business Analytics, Texas McCombs School of Business — Sep 2022

Professional coursework (Google): Grow as a Manager; Support Individual Growth and Development; Create a High-Performing Team; Set and Achieve Team Goals — Jan 2026

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

PMP Exam Prep (coursework), uCertify — Jul 2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Proposal Reviewer — Association for Institutional Research (AIR), 2027 AIR Forum — Nov 2026

SKILLS

BI & Visualization: Power BI (DAX, Power Query, semantic modeling, row-level security), Tableau

Data: SQL, SQL Server (SSMS), Python, Jupyter, statistical analysis, data modeling, data quality & validation, AWS

AI Production: Generative AI Video (Veo 3.1, Google Flow), AI Avatar Design & Direction, Prompt Engineering, Video Production & Compositing (FFmpeg, Python/PIL), Data Storytelling, Content Strategy, AI News Analysis, Audio Production, Editorial Verification, Voice & Audio Direction, Brand Identity & Logo Design, Animation & Performance Direction, Packaging & Retention Design, Trademark & Brand Protection, Intellectual Property Management

Professional: Prompt engineering, project management, stakeholder collaboration, institutional research & planning